6.5.2 Shape and Form

Shape

A specific configuration of the line or plane in 2-dimension is defined as shape, that separates a form from the background space. Shapes of clothing determine the outer shape of a person, as shape describes the outer dimensions of an object. The silhouette creates an impression about the person. The shape in a garment is either structural or decorative in nature. The shapes of garment may be modified in different ways. The shapes are introduced in garment through features such as bodice, skirt, sleeve, collar and yoke. When lines are joined to enclose space, they result in an outline joined to enclose a contour or shape. The garment shapes which could be applied for enhancing the comfort and beauty are expressed under.

6.5.2.1 Geometric Shapes

The 3 distinct types of geometric shapes are **rectilinear** – square or rectangle, **angular** – triangle or pyramid and **curvilinear** – circle, sphere cone and cylinder. Geometric shapes are structured and often symmetrical. Rectangle, trapezoids and parallelograms are modified squares. An oval shape is an elongated circle and pentagons, octagons and hexagons are created with a combination of rectangles and triangles. (Figure 6.14).

- **Rectangle**

Opposite sides of this shape are equal. Styles with these lines are slenderizing and suitable for the well proportioned, heavier women. It is influenced by three factors namely shape, size and position. The examples for a rectangular shape are garments with long, straight, hanging in loose, graceful folds.

- **Triangle**

Triangular shape is three sided. It may be formed also in an inverted position in the garments. It contributes unity and balance to the garments as it is stable. Examples are garments with wide shoulders, narrow skirt, dolman or raglan sleeves are good fashion design styles for large bust.

- **Square**

A square has all sides equal. It gives visual clarity due to its regularity. Examples are garments with straight or boat shaped neckline, boxy jackets and capes. Generally this style is very good for the very thin figured women, however, with proportions well planned and good design fabric can camouflage various figure irregularities.

- **Round**

The round shapes are suitable for formal wear or afternoon frocks. This design in fashion garments is the most attractive on the very young and the very thin figure. Examples for this shape are wide, crinoline lined skirts, petal shapes and puffed sleeves.

- **Hourglass**

Hourglass shape is natural and gives smooth fit over hips and full skirt at bottom. It also gives a very good appearance for the tall, thin figure. Examples: wide shoulders and leg of mutton sleeves.

- **Oval**

This shape is good for well proportioned, ideal figure. It is suitable especially for afternoon and evening wears.

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